UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2013

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **(Exam date : 19.05.2013)** **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Indus Valley Civilization

1. Which of the following characterizes/characterize the people of Indus Civilization?

1. They possessed great palaces and temples.
2. They worshipped both male and female deities.
3. They employed horse-drawn chariots in warfare.

Select the correct statement/ statements using the codes given below :

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) None of the statements given above is correct

Ans : (b) Excavation of Indus valley civilization has not found evidence of a place of worship or temple from any site. Evidence of worship of Matri Devi and Adya Shiva is found on the basis of female Terracotta figurines found from places like Harppa, Mohenjodaro. There is no clear evidence of horse from any site other than horse bone found at **Surkotada** in Indus civilization. For this reason, any evidences of a chariot drawn by horses are inaccessible.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata and Shaiva Religion

2. With reference to the history of philosophical thought in India, consider the following statements regarding Samkhya school.

1. Samkhya does not accept the theory of rebirth or transmigration of soul.
2. Samkhya holds that it is the self-knowledge that leads to liberation and not any exterior influence or agent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (b) The Samkhya school is part of the six orthodox schools of Indian philosophy. The Sage Kapila was the founder of Samkhya School. This school denies the existence of God. However, rebirth and transmigration of the soul are inherent in the Samkhya School. In Samkhya School, liberation results from the disappearance of the limitations of self-awareness. It is not from any external influence or agent.

3. Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two ?

(a) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks.
(b) Chaitya is a place of worship, while vihara is the dwelling place of the monks.
(c) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it.
(d) There is no material difference between the two.

Ans : (b) In Buddhist architecture, Chaitya is an assembly or prayer hall, which houses a Stupa. Vihara, on the other hand, is a dwelling or refuge for monks.

4. Which of the following statements is/ are applicable to jain doctrine ?

1. The surest way of annihilating Karma is to practice penance.
2. Every object, even the smallest particle has a soul.
3. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.

(a) 1only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans: (d) Mahavir Swami was the 24th Tirthankara of Jainism and he is believed to be the real founder of Jainism. The Jain text 'Acharang Sutra' states that the surest way to annihilate Karma is austerity. According to Jain philosophy, the soul resides in everything in the universe, even if it is the smallest particle. In Jain philosophy, the flow of the molecules of Karma towards the life 'Asrav', if the flow of the molecules of Karma stops towards the organism, the burning of residual Karma or the erosion of the already existing molecules is called 'Nirjara'. According to these principles, karma is the bane of the soul and it must be ended.

5. Which one of the following describes best the concept of Nirvana in Buddhism?

(a) The extinction of the flame of desire
(b) The complete annihilation of self
(c) A state of bliss and rest
(d) A mental stage beyond all comprehension

Ans : (a) According to Buddhism, the ultimate goal of human life is to attain Nirvana. Nirvana means the extinguishment of the flame of personal desires i.e. getting rid of the cycle of life and death. This Nirvana can be attained only when all the present desires cease and the desires arising in the future are destroyed from the root. In Nirvana, cravings and malice are ceased from the root, due to which one attains freedom from all kinds of suffering and the rebirth cycle of the world.

• Maurya & Post–Mauryan Period

6. With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements:

1. The caves at Badami are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India.
2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.
3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) only 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (c) The period of construction of rock- cut caves of Badami, Barabar, and Ellora was between the sixth century, to the first century B.C. and the fifth to seventh century B.C., respectively. The rock cut caves of Badami are not the oldest as the caves of Barabar, Ajanta and Ellora were built earlier. The Barabar rock-cut caves were built by Emperor Ashoka and the Ellora caves belonged to Jain, Buddhist and Hindu religions.

• Gupta Period & Post Gupta Period

7. Consider the following historical places :

1. Ajanta Caves
2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa

Which of the above places is/are also known for mural paintings ?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

Ans : (b) It is well known that the Ajanta caves have mural paintings. These paintings have Buddhist religious themes and depict the Jataka tales. The Lepakshi temple also has mural paintings of the Vijaynagara kings. The Sanchi Stupa, on the other hand, does not have mural paintings.

8. The Chinese traveller Yuan Chwang (Hiuen Tsang) who visited India recorded the general conditions and culture of India at that time . In this context, which of the following statements is/are correct .

1. The roads and river-routes were completely immune from robbery.
2. As regards punishment for offences, ordeals by fire, water and poison were the instruments for determining the innocence or guilt of a person .
3. The tradesmen had to pay duties at ferries and barrier stations.

Select the correct answer using the codes given

(a) 1 only 1 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (b) Chinese traveller Hiuen Tsang came to India during Harshavardhana (606-647 AD) time. According to him, public on the roads was not always completely safe. Hence statement (1) is wrong. According to him, for the crime or guilt/ innocent accomplishment, fire water and poison were subjected to a truth test. According to him, the tax was paid to the state by the merchants on the trading ghats, routes and items of sale. Hiuen Tsang biography 'Si-Yu-Ki' provides many important information in the context of political, social, religious and economic subjects of erstwhile India.

MODERN HISTORY

• Social-Cultural Awakening, Caste, Trade Union and Peasant Movement

9. Consider the following Bhakti Saints :

1. Dadu Dayal
2. Guru Nanak
3. Tyagaraja

Who among the above was/ were preaching When the Lodi dynasty fell and Babur took over?

(a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2

Ans : (b) The period of the Lodi dynasty was from 1451 to 1526. At this time, Guru Nanak (1469-1539) gave his Sermons. He conceived the formless God and called this God as a man of Famine. However, as per the question, other devotee Saint, Dadu-Dayal, was born in 1544 and died in 1603 A.D. and Tyagaraja was born in 1767 and died in 1847.

10. The demand for the Tebhaga Peasant Movement in Bengal was for

(a) the reduction of the share of the landlords from one-half of the crop to one-third.
(b) the grant of ownership of land to peasants as they were the actual cultivators of the land.
(c) The uprooting of Zamindari system and the end of serfdom.
(d) Writing off all peasant debts.

Ans : (a) The Tebhaga Peasant Movement was initiated in Bengal in 1946 by the Bengal Provincial Kisan Sabha to implement the Flood Commission recommendation, which asked for Share-croppers to give one-third of their harvest to the landowner instead of the one-half, which they were paying at that time. In its response, the Bargadari Act was passed, which provided that share croppers need to pay only one-third of their harvest to the landlords.

• Major Institutions, Treaties, Commissions & Acts

11. Annie Besant was

1. Responsible for starting the Home Rule Movement
2. The founder of the Theosophical Society
3. Once the President of the Indian National Congress

Select the correct statement/statements using the codes given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3